

# Apostrophes — Possession and Contraction

Year 5 | Grammar and Phonics

Aussie Primary  
Academy

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Australian Curriculum v9.0 | AC9E5LA06 | Year 5 | Understanding Language — Apostrophes

## LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to use apostrophes correctly to show possession (ownership) and contraction (shortened words).

## KEY IDEA

Apostrophes show 2 things: **POSSESSION** — the dog's bone (the bone belonging to the dog); **CONTRACTION** — don't = do not. For **PLURAL** possessives, apostrophe goes **AFTER** the s: the dogs' bones (bones belonging to multiple dogs). **NOTE:** 'its' (possession) has **NO** apostrophe — 'it's' always means 'it is'.

## WARM UP — QUICK CHECK!

Is this apostrophe showing possession or contraction? Explain:

'It's raining today but the dog wagged its tail anyway.'

\_\_\_\_\_

## A — SINGULAR POSSESSION

Rewrite each phrase using an apostrophe to show ownership:

Example: the bowl belonging to the cat  
→ the cat's bowl

1. the toy belonging to the dog →

\_\_\_\_\_

2. the bike belonging to Jack →

\_\_\_\_\_

3. the desk belonging to the teacher →

\_\_\_\_\_

4. the hat belonging to Mrs Smith →

\_\_\_\_\_

## B — PLURAL POSSESSION

1 dog's bone (one dog) vs the dogs' bones (more than one dog)

Rewrite using a plural possessive apostrophe:

1. the books belonging to the students →

\_\_\_\_\_

2. the bags belonging to the girls →

\_\_\_\_\_

3. the cars belonging to the teachers →

\_\_\_\_\_

## C — CONTRACTIONS

Write the contraction for each word pair:

do not

they  
are

cannot

I will

we  
have

she is

would  
not

I am

## D — FIND AND FIX THE ERROR

Find and correct the apostrophe mistake in each sentence:

1. The dogs bone was buried deep in the garden.

\_\_\_\_\_

2. Its a beautiful sunny day for a picnic today.

\_\_\_\_\_

3. The students bags were left in the wrong classroom.

\_\_\_\_\_

# Apostrophes — Possession and Contraction

Year 5 | Answer Guide & Extension

Aussie Primary  
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Name: \_\_\_\_\_

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## Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

**Warm Up:** 'It's' = contraction (it is). 'its' = possession (belonging to it) — no apostrophe needed.

**A1:** the dog's toy

**A2:** Jack's bike

**A3:** the teacher's desk

**A4:** Mrs Smith's hat

**B1:** the students' books

**B2:** the girls' bags

**B3:** the teachers' cars

**C:** don't, they're, can't, I'll, we've, she's, wouldn't, I'm.

**D1:** The dog's bone was buried deep in the garden.

**D2:** It's a beautiful sunny day for a picnic today.

**D3:** The students' bags were left in the wrong classroom.

**High Five! You are a Language Champion! ✓**  
Colour a star for each section you completed successfully:



## EXTENSION / CHALLENGE

Write a short paragraph (5-6 sentences) describing your weekend activities. Include at least 2 possessive apostrophes (singular AND plural) and 3 contractions, all used correctly.

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## PARENT TIP

Look for apostrophe examples on shop signs, books or packaging. Discuss whether each one shows possession or contraction — and whether it's being used correctly!

## TEACHER TIP

Teach 'its vs it's' explicitly as it is one of the most common written errors. Use editing exercises with deliberate apostrophe mistakes for students to identify and fix.

## STUDENT REFLECTION

[ ] I can use apostrophes correctly to show singular possession

[ ] I can use apostrophes correctly to show plural possession

[ ] I can use apostrophes correctly in contractions and avoid the 'its/it's' error